

General Lit.





About the Course

Journey into the 19th century via novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from and about the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12



Placement & Combining Tips

Some books shared with other high school grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 2 times/week 30 min	Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass Up from Slavery James Jane Eyre The Count of Monte Cristo Short stories and other writings Things Fall Apart The Souls of Black Folk

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

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☐ Jane Eyre (Term 2: Option 1) This novel touches on difficult themes, including a child in an unhappy home situation, loss, a romantic relationship with a significant secret, mental illness,

and questions of faith and duty. Teachers may wish to preview these elements before assigning.

☐ James (Term 2: Option 2) This novel is recommended for mature students, as it includes strong language, racial slurs and stereotypes, and graphic scenes of violence and abuse, mainly directed towards the enslaved characters in the novel. These scenes intensify toward the end of the novel. Pre-reading or familiarizing yourself with the content to determine suitability for your student(s) is encouraged. Frankenstein or Silas Marner from General Lit.: Grades 9-10 are also possible alternatives.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 11-12



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Up from Slavery



James



Jane Eyre



The Count of Monte Cristo

Short stories and other writings



Things Fall Apart



The Souls of Black Folk



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

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code for links.



General Lit.: Grades 11-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ INTRO

Alexandre Dumas's *The Count of Monte Cristo* is a well-loved story of betrayal, revenge, and redemption. It was originally written as a serial, so as you read, imagine the experience of the first readers who were continuously given cliff hangers and had to wait for the next installment of the plot!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Plan to read for about 20 minutes each week and leave 10 minutes for narration and discussion. The edition chosen for this course is the abridged version, but it is still too long to cover in two terms just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time. Or just read 20 minutes each week, and if you are interested, you can finish the book after the end of the term.

- There are a lot of characters in this novel! Begin a character list today, and jot down a few details. What kind of man is Edmond Dantès at the opening of the novel?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography that details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer."

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading?
 - What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.
-

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

Today, we begin reading the autobiography of Booker T. Washington. It was first written as a periodical, but was later put into book form. Washington was born a slave, but was still a child when emancipation occurred. He later founded Tuskegee Institute in Alabama and spent his life advancing the cause of equal rights. His writings give a window into the Reconstruction period that followed the American Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.1-11 "I was born" - "owners as to the future."

- How does Washington describe his childhood? How does he describe the day of emancipation?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: Douglass's *Narrative* contains several graphic descriptions of beatings and racial slurs.

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Term 1

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think has happened at the party?
- Describe the character of Mercédès and continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.11-22 "After the coming of freedom" - "or a handkerchief."

- Why were names so important to Washington and the other newly freed people?
- How does Washington describe the conditions of formerly enslaved people immediately after emancipation?
- How is education described in this chapter? Why did Washington see it as so important?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think of the character of Villefort? What is his secret?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)



Term 1

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
 - Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.22-34 "Finally, the great day came" - "get through the school year."

- What hardships does he encounter while traveling, and how does he respond to them? Where does he find the strength to persevere?
- Describe Mrs. Ruffner and how she impacted his life. Who else had an impact on Washington?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What is the political situation in France as the action of the novel begins?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 8

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-26 "But alas!" - "learning how to write."

- How did Douglass's experiences with the Aulds set him "on the pathway from slavery to freedom"? Why did Mr. Auld forbid his wife to teach Douglass to read, and what did Douglass learn from this about literacy?
 - How does Douglass teach himself to read and write? What obstacles does he face, and what does he learn about his own situation from what he reads?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-6 p.34-50 "Three weeks before" - "features of the institution."

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Term 1

- Why does he believe education should include both academic learning and practical skills? How does Washington begin helping other members of his community?
- What opportunities and challenges arose for formerly enslaved people during the Reconstruction period? What aspects is Washington most critical of?
- What does Washington learn from his experience working with Native Americans?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What is Dantès's life like as a prisoner? How has he spent the years of his imprisonment so far?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 10

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-33 "In a very short time" - "sagacity to see it."

- What was Douglass's and the other slaves' situation when his master, Captain Anthony, died? How does Douglass's direct description of valuation strengthen his argument against slavery?
- What is Douglass's life like once he lives with Thomas Auld?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.51-64 "During the time" - "deeply as this one."

- What challenges did Washington face when he went to Tuskegee? What do we learn about his leadership style from how he faced these difficulties?
- Why does Washington praise manual labor so highly? What episodes from his younger years influenced the importance he placed on this type of work?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

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- Which characters do you trust? Which ones are you suspicious of? Jot down some initial impressions, and it will be interesting for you to refer back to them as you get further into the novel.
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 12

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-39 "While I lived with my master" - "myself to my wretched lot."

- Why does Douglass call Edward Covey a "slave breaker"? What methods does Covey use to control enslaved people?
 - How does Douglass describe the physical and emotional effects of his time with Covey?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.64-74 "The coming of Christmas" - "or perhaps could build."

- How did the community support the school in Tuskegee?
- Why is it important for Washington to teach his students to "love work for its own sake" (72)?
- What lesson did Washington learn from brick-making about racial relations?

★ TEACHER NOTE
Sensitive content in a quotation: Up From Slavery p.68.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 13

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- How would you describe the character of Faria? What is his secret? What role does he play in Dantès's life?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 14

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-45 "I have already intimated" - "practice is a very common one."

- Why do you think Douglass describes "this battle with Mr. Covey [as]



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the turning point in my career as a slave"?

- How does Douglass describe the celebration of Christmas for slaves as a tool of control rather than genuine kindness? How does this description support his anti-slavery argument?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.74-85 "The same principle" - "button is to be found missing."

- What challenges did Washington continue to face in setting up Tuskegee? How did he face them, and what can you learn from his perseverance?
- What were some lessons that Washington was trying to teach the students beyond the classroom?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- How does Dantès escape? How does he use the lessons he learned from Faria in prison to aid his plan?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 16

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-52 "On the first of January" - "we succeeded very well."

- How does this section show the hypocrisy between the slave-holders' professions of Christianity and their actions?
- How does Douglass describe his time with Mr. Freeland?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

(We are skipping chapters 12-13.)

Ch.14 p.105-115 "The Atlanta Exposition" - "exact justice to both races."

- What does Washington mean by "Cast down your bucket where you are"?
- How would you describe the overall message of his speech? How was it received?

→ LISTEN

The only audio recording of Booker T. Washington in existence is him

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reading the opening paragraphs of his Atlanta Exposition Speech in 1905.
∞ Audio Link: Booker T. Washington's "Atlanta Compromise" Speech

→ WATCH

This short biography of Booker T. Washington also introduces the debate with W. E. B. Du Bois, which will be the focus of the next three lessons.

∞ Video Link: Booker T. Washington: Founder of Tuskegee University & Champion for Civil Rights

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think Dantès will do once he is free?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore."

- What is Douglass's plan to escape to freedom? What happens?
- How does Douglass's experience working at the shipyard demonstrate the injustices of the law?

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

W. E. B. Du Bois was a prominent writer, sociologist, historian, and advocate for civil rights. He was raised in Massachusetts and attended Fisk University and then Harvard, where he became the first African American to receive a PhD. He devoted his life to working for full equality for African Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "The Forethought" & Chapter 1: Of Our Spiritual Strivings

- Compare his aims and writing style to Washington's: what are some similarities and differences?
- Du Bois introduces two significant metaphors in today's reading: his concept of the "Veil" and of "double consciousness." How would you explain them to someone?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 19

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

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Term 1

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What role does faith play in Dantès's story?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 20

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.58-63 "Master Hugh, finding he could" - "for the reasons before mentioned."

- Why doesn't Douglass provide more details about how he escaped?
 - What does it mean for Douglass to "hire his time," and how does this practice reinforce the injustices of slavery?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

What do you recall from your reading last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-25 Chapter 3: Of Booker T. Washington and Others

- How does Du Bois describe Washington's life and work?
- What are some of his critiques of the "Atlanta Compromise" and Washington's priorities?
- Compare the two men's views on education: what kinds of education do they each advocate?"

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more background on Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois's differing views, the following overview from Yale's Teachers Institute is helpful if your students have additional questions.

∞ Link: Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois: The Problem of Negro Leadership

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 21

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Why do you think Caderousse was Dantès's first stop? What can Dantès do in disguise that he wouldn't be able to do if he revealed his true self to his former friends and acquaintances?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 22

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-69 "I have been frequently asked" - "with my labors to decide."

- How does Douglass describe the feeling of finally being free?

• COMPOSITION

What passages in either Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery illustrated the importance of education and literacy? Jot down your initial thoughts, then look back at the book and read or skim sections to discover relevant passages or ideas you might have forgotten. Look for both explicit and implicit ways the author makes a point. In other words,

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- What circumstances prompt him to begin speaking and working as an abolitionist?

→ VIEW

Learn more about Frederick Douglass's later life.

∞ Video Link: Frederick Douglass: First African American Nominated for Vice President

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-36 Chapter 5: Of the Wings of Atalanta

- Why does Du Bois draw on the myth of Atalanta and the golden apples in this chapter?
- At the end of this chapter, he writes: "We are training not isolated men but a living group of men,—nay, a group within a group. And the final product of our training must be neither a psychologist nor a brickmason, but a man" (36). Can you explain what he means in your own words? What does this argument tell us about how he views the purpose of education?

look for ways the author conveys ideas through both "showing" and "telling."

• EXTRA HELPING

The poet Dudley Randall wrote a poem about the debate between Washington and Du Bois.

∞ Link: Booker T. and W.E.B.

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

The Count of Monte Cristo

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

OR

Up from Slavery & The Souls of Black Folks

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Why do you think Caderousse was Dantès's first stop? What can Dantès do in disguise that he wouldn't be able to do if he revealed his true self to his former friends and acquaintances?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Orient yourself a bit more to Jane Eyre.

→ NOTE

This book is too long to finish in the term, just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time, or if you are interested, finish it after the end of the term.

→ READ

p.3 "Introduction to the Author" and p.10 "Background of the Work"
Ch.1 p.32-39

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- The first sentence of this novel is the famous: "There was no possibility of taking a walk that day." What is evoked by this sentence? What does it assume, deny, or allude to?
- View question #2 or #3 on p.263 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: JAMES)

Percival Everett described his novel James as a conversation with Mark Twain's The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn, where events from Twain's novel are reimagined from the perspective of Jim, the runaway slave. It won the Pulitzer Prize in 2025, and the committee described it as "an accomplished reconsideration of Huckleberry Finn that gives agency to Jim to illustrate the absurdity of racial supremacy and provide a new take on the search for family and freedom."

→ NOTE

This book is too long to finish in the term, just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time, or if you are interested, finish it after the end of the term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.1 p.9-20

- What do we learn about the character of James in this opening chapter? How are his two manners of speaking connected to his identity?
- What is the first interaction like between James and Huck?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See Planning & Prep for content considerations.

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Term 2

2. ∞ Link: Huckleberry Finn Chapter 2 opening scene

- What do you notice reading these two scenes back to back? How does Percival Everett reimagine the scene from Huckleberry Finn? Which details does he keep, and what does he change? What is the overall effect?

WEEK 2 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 27

□ Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What are some of the themes that you recognize in the novel so far? Does it remind you of any other books you have read?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 28

□ Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

How was Jane's "nature" (her personality) portrayed in chapter one, and what role does it have in the plot so far?

→ INTRO

Keep the idea of the quest in mind while reading the novel. What is Jane's quest? What is she looking for? Is what she wants the same as what she needs?

→ READ

Ch.2-3 p.40-63

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- What is the significance of the first words of chapter 2 in terms of Jane's development of her sense of self?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What are your first impressions of the character of Jim?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.21-32

- What do you learn about language in this section? How does it contribute to the irony of the novel?

→ VIEW

Understanding Everett's aims and vision for James as you begin the novel will serve as a helpful guide as you read through it.

∞ Video Link: Giving "James" a Voice: Percival Everett on his Reimagining of Huck Finn

• COMPOSITION

How does the scene in the red room reflect Gothic literature? (Elements of Gothic literature include mystery, death, the supernatural, gloom and doom, and horror.) Notice details such as the secret drawer in the wardrobe, the jewel-casket, and parchment, along with words such as spell, secret, blood, and chill. Does the scene become too unrealistic to be believable, or does Brontë succeed in making it realistic?

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Term 2

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What are your thoughts on the pacing of the narrative? Remember that The Count of Monte Cristo was originally published in installments. Do you think that format dictated any elements of the narrative?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What happened last time as Jane recovered from the red room?

→ READ

Ch.4 p.64-86 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #7 or #8 on p.264 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What stood out to you the most from the last reading? What questions do you have at this point in your reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-6 p.33-52

- Why do you think James is helping and protecting Huck when doing so puts him in danger?
- Why is James drawn to reading Enlightenment thinkers such as Voltaire, who wrote about freedom and equality while also espousing racist views? What does his fever-dream debate with Voltaire tell us about James's views and self-education?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: About The Brontes

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 31

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Consider the character of Dantès/The Count. Do you recognize any of the traits he possessed at the beginning of the novel? Or did his time in prison transform him into a completely different person? Have you disapproved of any of his actions so far?



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WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 32

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

In the last chapter, Jane was to be sent to Lowood Institution. Tell back what you remember.

→ READ

Ch.5 p.86-105 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #9 or #10 on p.264-265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

Tell back what you remember about why James is on the run and why it is so much more dangerous for him with Huck along.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-10 p.53-70

- Reread what James wrote on p.55. He has never had the opportunity to write before: why do you think these are the words he composes first?
- Why does James not agree to go across the river to Illinois?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Review your character list: what early opinions about some of the characters are you beginning to change? Take some time to add to your notes about characters if you are behind.

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 34

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What is Lowood Institution like so far?

→ READ

Ch.6-7 p.105-129 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #11 or #12 on p.264-265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----



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→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your reading last week about the relationship between Huck and James?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11-15 p.71-92

- Why is reading such a dangerous act? Why does James want to hide it from Huck? What realization does he have about the power of reading?
- What are some examples of irony that you have come across so far? Irony can be verbal (characters saying the opposite of what they mean), situational (the opposite of what one might expect happens), or dramatic (the reader/audience knows more than the character).

WEEK 6 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 35

□ Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Which character are you enjoying reading about the most? Which character the least? Why?

WEEK 6 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 36

□ Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Tell what you remember about Jane's friendship with Helen Burns.

→ READ

Ch.8-9 p.130-153 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #13 or #14 on p.265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-19 p.93-113

- What does having a pencil mean to James? What did the risk cost George, and how does this change James's relationship with the pencil?
- What does James mean when he writes, "With myself I wrote myself into being. I wrote myself to here."? How does this reflect back on Everett's vision for his novel?
- Soon after James writes these words, there is a retelling of a scene from Huckleberry Finn when Jim and Huck reunite, and Huck witnesses the feud between the Harney and Grangerford families. If you are familiar with Twain's novel, how does Everett adapt this story into his own?

• COMPOSITION

Helen's moving deathbed scene is a central moment in Jane's life, in her faith, and in her development as a character. Write about the literary, emotional, and theological significance of this scene.

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WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 37

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Reflect back on what you have read so far. What do you think of the pacing of the plot? Is it uneven? Too fast or slow? Would you describe the novel as a "page turner"? Is there a scene that you think would be a compelling scene in a play?

• COMPOSITION - Script

Choose a scene you have read so far in The Count of Monte Cristo, and rewrite it as a script for a play or movie.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 38

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What do you think will happen next in the story?

→ READ

Ch.10 p.153-169 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- What does it tell us about Jane that it takes Miss Temple's departure, rather than her own ambition, to push her toward a new life? Is she being passive, or is there something else going on?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from last week about the introduction of the Duke and the King?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-22 p.114-132

- What happens at the revival?
- Why are James and Huck in so much more danger once they cross paths with the Duke and the King?
- If you know Twain's original story, discuss how Everett is adapting it with these episodes.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 39

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think the novel is trying to say about the relationship

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between revenge and justice? If Dantès had acted differently, do you see a way that he could have sought justice and cleared his name?

- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 40

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Tell about Jane's reunion with Bessie in the last chapter.

→ READ

Ch.11 p.169-193 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #17 on p.265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What did you learn in last week's reading about Huck's mother? Why doesn't James feel free to speak to Huck about her?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23-25 p.133-148

- How is the relationship between James and Huck beginning to change?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 41

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think the novel is trying to say about the relationship between revenge and justice? If Dantès had acted differently, do you see a way that he could have sought justice and cleared his name?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 42

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What happens when Jane arrives at Thornfield Hall?

→ READ

Ch.12 p.193-208 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).



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- View question #18 on p.265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you remember from last week about James's interaction with Easter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-29 p.149-169

- How is James being sold to Emmett so that he can sing with the Virginia Minstrels an example of irony?
- What do you think of the character of Emmett? Do you think he is trustworthy?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 43

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Since The Count of Monte Cristo was published in the mid-1840s, there has been a debate about what type of book it is. Some have seen it as a literary masterpiece, while others argue it is a precursor to popular pulp fiction. Do you have an opinion one way or another? Can you find examples that support and refute both sides of the debate?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 44

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

How did Jane meet Mr. Rochester?

→ NOTE

This week is a longer reading. You can split this lesson between two days this week, or read some in your free time.

→ READ

Ch.13-14 p.209-244 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- Why do you think Brontë introduces Rochester as someone who breaks the rules of polite behavior? How does Jane's refusal to defer to him set up their relationship as something different from the typical governess-employer dynamic?

Do you find Rochester sympathetic at this point in the novel, or does something about him make you uneasy?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from last week about the members of the Virginia



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Minstrels?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30-Part 2 Ch.1 p.170-196

- Why do you think it is at this stage of the story that James is beginning to experience some new, complicated feelings - "a good bad feeling," he calls one of them (176)?
- What do you think of the songs Emmett writes? Why does James think they need to be part of his story? (All the songs are included as a preface to the novel; if you want to review them.)
- What has the pencil come to mean to James?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 45

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- At whatever point you are at in the novel, think about how you would describe Dantès/The Count of Monte Cristo. Is he the hero of the story? Is he a tragic anti-hero figure, like a good guy gone wrong? Or is he an outright villain?
- Several weeks ago, you reflected on the relationship between revenge and justice. Today, consider the question of morality. What actions taken by Dantès have been moral? Do you see him as fundamentally a moral character, or the opposite?
- Review your character list. How have the characters changed since your first impressions of them?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 46

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What do you think will happen next in the story?

→ READ

Ch.15 p.244-262 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- Jane knows her feelings for Rochester are dangerous and tries to talk herself out of them. Why does she distrust her own emotions here, and is she right to?
 - What do we know at this point in the story that Jane doesn't?
 - What images and scenes come to mind when you think of this story? How would you describe it (so far) to someone who had never read it?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your last reading of James?

• COMPOSITION

It was common in this era for women to paint and participate in other ornamental arts. How does Brontë enliven this cliché in using Jane's paintings to reveal her inner psyche and to advance the plot?

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.2-5 p.197-217	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Count of Monte Cristo	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Jane Eyre OR James	

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WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 49

"The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

We've included audio versions of these stories as an alternative to reading the written stories. Short stories can be especially fun to hear aloud with a talented narrator, though it will take longer than reading the story.

Mark Twain (1835–1910) is the pen name of Samuel Clemens, one of America's most celebrated writers, who was known for his sharp wit. His most famous works include *The Adventures of Tom Sawyer* and *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*. Published in 1865, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog" was the story that made Twain a household name. The story blends exaggeration and comic timing in a way that was fresh and distinctly American when it was published. As you read, pay attention not just to what happens, but to how the story is told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.2-5 "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What makes Simon Wheeler's way of telling his story just as funny as the story itself? Can you think of another story, movie, or TV show where the delivery matters as much as the punchline?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

In the second week of this term, we'll read "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry, which is a Christmas story. Feel free to reschedule this story for closer to Christmas if desired.

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 50

Introduction - Things Fall Apart

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ INTRO

Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe tells the story of the Igbo tribe in nineteenth-century Nigeria through the life of Okonkwo, a prominent and proud warrior at the center of his community. The story is divided into three parts: Part 1 depicts Okonkwo's life, family, and the culture of his tribe; in Part 2, Okonkwo has been exiled, and in the intervening seven years, missionaries and colonial administrators have come to the village of Umuofia; and in Part 3, Okonkwo returns to a changed village.

Achebe is careful not to present a romanticized or sanitized representation of the Igbo way of life. This novel is recommended for mature students, as it contains scenes of violence, including domestic violence, killings, and ritual practices that are unsettling both to readers and characters within the story.

→ VIEW

The following two videos will provide a helpful, interpretive framework for approaching the novel. Achebe wrote about the importance of having a "balance of stories," and this is a helpful concept to keep in mind as you read the novel.

∞ Video Link: Achebe Discusses Africa 50 Years After 'Things Fall Apart'

∞ Video Link: Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: The Danger of a Single Story

→ STUDY

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These two videos will take up nearly the whole lesson time, but also take a minute to review the Glossary on p.211-212. You will want to consult this list as you read throughout the term.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 51

"The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter (1862–1910), an American writer famous for his short stories about ordinary people — especially the working poor of New York City. His warm, ironic style made him one of the most popular writers of his era. Published in 1905, "The Gift of the Magi" is perhaps his most beloved story. If you have extra time, his biography (see video link) is especially interesting.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.6-9 "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Were Jim and Della's sacrifices generous or just foolish? Why?
- Where did O. Henry plant clues about the twist ending? Did any of them tip you off while you were reading?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: O. Henry bio

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 52

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What did you find most helpful from the videos last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-3 p.3-25

- How would you describe Okonkwo's relationship with his father, Unoka? How are the two men different from each other? Do you see any ways they are similar?
- Why does Ikemefuna come to live with Okonkwo's family?
- Write a brief character sketch of Okonkwo.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 53

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Edgar Allan Poe (1809–1849) is one of America's most distinctive and influential writers. Poe is known for dark, atmospheric tales of mystery and the macabre. Surprisingly, he also pioneered the detective story! Poe had a fascination with puzzles, codes, and the power of careful reasoning. Published in 1843, "The Gold Bug" is a mystery with a secret message written in code, and cracking it requires sharp eyes and sharp thinking. As you read, pay close attention when the cipher appears and to how the code is broken. If you'd like, see if you can work through it yourself!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.10-17 (stop at "we shall see!")

- How would you describe Legrand and Jupiter from what you've read so

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Gold Bug" contains a repeated racial slur. Please preview for your students.

If you have already read this story, you may substitute "The Old Nurse's Story" by Elizabeth Gaskell. (Also included in the PDF for this course on p.38-50)

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→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Video Link: Edgar Allan Poe bio

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 54

📄 Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ **RECAP**

What do you remember about the character of Okonkwo from last week?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.4-5 p.26-45

- What is Okonkwo's family structure? How does his treatment of his family reveal his values and fears?
- Why is Okonkwo afraid of being seen as weak?
- What cultural values are emphasized during the Week of Peace and the Festival of the Yam? What role does the yam play in the economy and life of the village?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 55

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

📄 Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ **RECAP**

What do you think will happen next during their adventure?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.17-23 "We crossed the creek" - "we had been digging."

- Does the narrator believe Legrand? What does he think has happened to Legrand? Do you agree?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 56

📄 Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ **RECAP**

Where did you leave off in the story last week?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.6-7 p.46-62

- Describe the character of Chielo. She is both a priestess and, in "ordinary life," a woman who works at the market. What does this reveal about Igbo religious beliefs and the roles of individuals?
- How has Ikemefuna begun to change Okonkwo's family? How has he affected Nwoye?
- How is Okonkwo's killing of Ikemefuna a turning point in the novel? Why does he do it when he was forbidden to do it by an elder?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 57

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

📄 Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ **RECAP**

What has happened so far during their adventure, especially while at the tree?

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.23-29 "Around the new position" - "place of deposit."

- The narrator immediately demands an explanation rather than simply celebrating when the treasure is found. Why do you think this is?
- We are told very little about who the narrator is. What do you know so far? Why do you think we are told so little?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 58

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9 p.63-86

- What advice does Obierika offer to Okonkwo, either directly or indirectly? How does Obierika view tradition and ritual differently from Okonkwo?
- What does the story of Ezinma and the iyi-uwa reveal about Igbo spiritual beliefs?
- What is the place of women in Igbo culture? Why must they often hide their thoughts and emotions?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 59

The Gold Bug by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What "links" of logic has Legrand revealed so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.30-37

- How much of finding the treasure was logic and how much was luck, in your opinion?

• COMPOSITION

"The Gold Bug" is considered an early template for detective fiction. What elements fit that mold? What's missing that later detective stories (such as Sherlock Holmes) add?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 60

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Ezinma from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.87-109

- What does the ceremony in chapter 10 show the reader about how law, order, justice, and restitution are handled in Igbo society? What are egwugwu?
- The male ceremony is juxtaposed with a female ritual: Chielo's prophecy and journey with Ezinma to the house of Agbala - how do justice and religion work together to maintain the social order?
- What glimpses of Okonkwo do we see beyond his public persona in today's reading?



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WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 61

"The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Alexander Pushkin (1799–1837) is Russia's most celebrated and beloved writer, widely considered the father of modern Russian literature. His poetry, novels, and stories established the literary tradition that nearly every Russian writer after him would build upon. Written in 1834, "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" is one of his narrative poems written in the style of a Russian folktale. The story reads like a fairy tale but carries the sharp edge of a fable. As you read, ask yourself who holds the real power in this story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.51-56 "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin
∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What kind of ruler is the king at the beginning of the story, and does your opinion of him change as the story progresses?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Web Link: Alexander Pushkin bio

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 62

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about ceremonies from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13 p.110-125

- What does the marriage ceremony reveal about Igbo values?
- What role did Ezeudu play in Okonkwo's story?
- Why does Okonkwo need to be exiled for seven years? And why is his home destroyed by those who "had no hatred in their hearts" against him?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 63

"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Leo Tolstoy (1828–1910) is best known for lengthy novels like War and Peace and Anna Karenina. But Tolstoy was also a master of the short story, and late in his life he turned increasingly toward simple, moral tales. Published in 1886, "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is one of those tales. As you read, watch for how Tolstoy uses one man's desires to build suspense and make his argument.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.57-68 "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy
∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- At the end of the story, the title's question is answered. Did the answer surprise you, or did you see it coming? Why?



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WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 64

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Okonkwo's exile from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-16 p.129-147

- Why do you think it is important for Achebe to preserve so many proverbs by including them in the characters' dialogue? Earlier in the story, we read "Among the Ibo the art of conversation is regarded very highly, and proverbs are the palm-oil with which words are eaten" (7). What do you think this means?
- Describe the character of Uchendu. How does he compare to Okonkwo?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 65

"The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and philosopher from India who became the first non-European writer to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, receiving it in 1913. He was a prolific writer of poetry, short stories, novels, and plays, and is still considered one of the greatest literary figures of the modern era. His short story "The Kingdom of Cards" is written in the style of a fairy tale and uses an imaginary world to say something true about the real one.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.69-74 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Would you want to live in the Kingdom of Cards? What does your answer say about what you value?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 66

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what life is like for Okonkwo's family in exile from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17-19 p.148-167

- How have the missionaries begun to change Mbanta? Why do you think Nwoye is drawn to them?
- Why are others who have been marginalized in Igbo culture drawn to Christianity?
- How does Achebe show both strengths and weaknesses of traditional culture?



Term 3

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 67

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) was a British writer (born in Edinburgh, Scotland) and best known as the creator of Sherlock Holmes, arguably the most famous fictional detective in the world. He was knighted by King Edward VII in 1902. The Holmes stories defined the modern detective story and have never gone out of print. "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" is widely considered one of the finest Holmes stories ever written. As you read, pay attention to the clues Doyle plants along the way, and see how much you can figure out before he reveals the answer.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.75-85 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Julia's mysterious dying words are "the speckled band"! Why do you think a dying clue is such a common device in detective fiction?
- Helen has been moved into her dead sister's room because of renovations, and this makes Holmes suspicious. Why do you think Helen herself didn't question it more?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Arthur Conan Doyle bio

• COMPOSITION

Holmes asks Watson to come along to Stoke Moran, warning him there will be danger. Why do you think Watson agrees to come? Is Watson loyal, brave, or does he simply trust Holmes?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 68

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the coming of missionaries and colonial government agents from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-23 p.171-191

- How has Umuofia changed in the seven years? What is different for Okonkwo when he returns?
- What is the role of education in the work of the missionaries and the colonial government?
- How does Achebe build tension throughout these chapters until the arrests in chapter 23?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 69

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.86-95 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Holmes notices what others ignore. Is that a matter of intelligence, training, habit, or something else entirely?
- Arthur Conan Doyle considered this the best of all his Sherlock Holmes stories. (You can read his top 12 at the link below.) What do you think makes it so enduring? How does it compare to Poe's "The Gold Bug"?



Term 3	
(written almost 50 years prior) as a piece of detective fiction?	
→ VIEW (OPTIONAL) ∞ Link: Arthur Conan Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories	
WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 70	
Materials: Things Fall Apart	
→ RECAP What do you recall from the reading last week?	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.24-25 p.192-209	
• Was the ending unexpected to you? What do you think of the final paragraph of the book? How does it reflect back on all that has come before? • The title of the novel comes from a poem called "The Second Coming" by William Butler Yeats. If you have time, read it and reflect on why Achebe chose it as his title. You may also consider why he chose to write this story in English. ∞ Link: The Second Coming	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 71 Exam Week	
→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
Questions will come from: Short Stories and Folk Tales	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 72 Exam Week	
→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
Questions will come from: Things Fall Apart	

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Examination

Term 1

- Count of Monte Cristo: Describe Edmond Dantès's relationship with Faria; in what ways are they father and son, as Faria claims (72)? How does Faria equip Dantès for his life after prison? OR Write a character sketch of Dantès at the very beginning of the novel, before he is arrested.
- Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass: Explain why reading and literacy were such an important first step in Douglass's path from slavery to freedom. OR Describe some of the ways Douglass's Narrative is such a powerful argument against slavery.
- Up from Slavery & Souls of Black Folk: Describe Washington's and Du Bois's differing views on the purpose of education. OR Tell all you know about Washington's early life and how it impacted his future leadership at the Tuskegee school.

Term 2

- The Count of Monte Cristo: The final sentence of the novel is: "The count just told us that all human wisdom was contained in these two words: Wait and hope." No matter where you left off in the novel, reflect on how what you have read so far supports this conclusion. OR Write a character sketch of Dantès/The Count of Monte Cristo at the point in the novel where you stopped reading. How has he changed from the beginning of the story?
- Jane Eyre: What are some ways in which Brontë builds mystery and suspense in the first volume? OR What is the basis of the mutual attraction between Jane and Mr. Rochester? Does their attraction seem realistic or romantic? Or both?
- James: Reflect on Percival Everett's use of irony in the novel. Why is this the mode he chooses when telling James's story? OR Discuss the importance of literacy, literature, and writing in the novel. Can you connect it to other books you have read this year?

Term 3

- Short Stories and Folk Tales: Choose one story from this term that ends with a "twist" and explain how its ending works. What does it reveal? Why is it effective? What do you think the author most wanted you to take away? OR Poe's Legrand and Doyle's Sherlock Holmes both solve mysteries through observation and logic, but they are very different kinds of characters. Compare and contrast the two. Which one did you find more compelling and why?
- Readers have often compared the narrative arc of Things Fall Apart to a Greek or Shakespearean tragedy. Using what you know about the genre and conventions of tragedy, would you agree with this? Make reference to specific episodes and characters from the novel. OR Choose one main character from the novel and consider how they change from the beginning of the novel to after the missionaries and colonial government arrive.